Spring Boot uses HikariCP for connection pooling, and you can configure it from the application.yml file. You want to configure at least a connection timeout (`spring.datasource.hikari.connection-timeout`) and a maximum number of connections in the pool (`spring.datasource.hikari.maximum-pool-size`), because these both affect application resilience and performance. As you saw for the Tomcat thread pool, multiple factors influence which values you should use. As a starting point, you can refer to the HikariCP analysis of pool sizing (https://github.com/brettwooldridge/HikariCP/wiki/About-Pool-Sizing).

Listing 5.3 Configuring the connection pool to interact with the database

```
spring:
  datasource:
    username: user
    password: password
    url: jdbc:postgresql://localhost:5432/polardb_catalog
    hikari:
      connection-timeout: 2000      ❶
      maximum-pool-size: 5          ❷
```

❶ The maximum time (ms) to spend waiting to get a connection from the pool

❷ The maximum number of connections HikariCP will keep in the pool

Now that you have connected a Spring Boot application to a PostgreSQL database, you can go ahead and define what data you want to persist.

5.2.2 Defining persistent entities with Spring Data

In Catalog Service, you already have a `Book` record representing a domain entity for the application. Depending on the business domain and its complexity, you might want to distinguish the domain entity from the persistent entity, making the domain layer utterly independent of the